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| Expat Well-being |



A reflective programme for orientation, clarity, and life between cultures.

"If well-being is the sail of the soul, you have to make peace with the winds" – George

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Expat Wellbeing

Moving to another country changes much more than where we live. Our language, relationships, routines, social roles and sense of belonging can all shift — and sometimes we only realise how important those familiar reference points were once they are no longer there.

Having lived abroad myself for more than twenty years, I combine this lived experience with my background in psychology to offer **interactive workshops for people navigating life between cultures**.

The workshops explore themes such as identity and belonging, cultural adaptation, uncertainty, relationships, stress, loneliness and the experience of feeling caught between different worlds. We also look at how our expectations, perceptions and previous experiences can influence the way we interpret a new environment.

Through accessible psychology, discussion, practical exercises and guided reflection, participants are encouraged to step back and understand where they are now, what may be influencing their wellbeing, and what could help them find greater stability and connection in their new environment.

There is no single correct way to adapt to another culture, and the aim is not to tell people how they should feel or who they should become. It is to create space for **orientation, understanding and choice** — while recognising that building a life somewhere new takes time.

Workshops can be organised for **companies, international organisations, associations, schools and groups**, and adapted to the experiences and needs of the people taking part.

Areas of Exploration

1. Context & Orientation: "Where am I… practically, culturally, and personally?"

We begin by mapping your current situation: the realities of living in Switzerland, the systems you interact with, and the transitions you've undergone. This stage supports orientation rather than catharsis — understanding the terrain before trying to navigate it.

2. Identity in Transition: "Who am I becoming in this environment?"

Relocation often alters roles, reference points, and self-understanding. This stage explores how identity shifts in response to cultural context, language, work structures, and social norms — without assuming loss, damage, or deficiency.

3. Presentation & Belonging: "How do I relate to others here?"

We reflect on how you present yourself in a new cultural environment, how belonging is negotiated, and how difference is managed. The focus is on awareness of patterns, not correction or adaptation pressure.

4. Relationship to Place: "How do I experience this environment?"

This stage looks at how place, pace, and local culture influence perception and interpretation. Rather than judging the experience as positive or negative, the aim is to understand how meaning is constructed in your new setting.

5. Expanding the Familiar: "What lies outside my habitual ways of living?"

Relocation often narrows life temporarily as routines are rebuilt. This stage supports reflection on what has become constrained or habitual, and what new possibilities may be available, without prescribing change.

6. Interpreting Social Signals: "How do I understand others' behaviour here?"

Cultural difference frequently leads to misinterpretation. This stage focuses on examining assumptions, expectations, and habitual interpretations of others' actions within a different cultural framework.

7. Situation Awareness: "What is actually happening, beyond my assumptions?"

We step back to integrate insights from earlier stages, distinguishing between context, interpretation, and choice. The emphasis is on perspective rather than conclusion.

8. Integration & Practical Orientation: "How do I move forward with greater clarity?"

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The final stage brings together reflections from the programme and supports the development of a practical, context-appropriate orientation for daily life, grounded in understanding rather than emotional resolution.

What This Programme is… and is not

This programme is:

- Reflective and consultative
- Psychology-informed at a theoretical level
- Focused on orientation, perspective, and coherence during transition

This programme is not:

- Psychotherapy or counselling
- Emotional or psychological support
- Mental health treatment or diagnosis

It is intended for adults seeking structured reflection around relocation and cultural transition.

Practical Details

If this approach resonates, you're welcome to get in touch to discuss whether the programme is appropriate for your current situation.

Bespoke workshops and longer programmes are available on request.

If you would like to offer your international employees, members or community a space to better understand the experience of living between cultures, **get in touch and we can discuss what would be most useful.**

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